Time Management: Facilitator Guide

Business Academy Group Learning · Time Management · July 2027

Session at a glance

In 60 minutes, providers look at where their time actually goes, protect time for business tasks, and choose one task to batch, simplify, or hand off.

Item	Detail
Month	July 2027
Audience	Business Academy providers, center-based and home-based
Length	60 minutes
Format	[In person / virtual]
Materials	Time audit worksheet (one week, 30-minute blocks), sample weekly business schedule, colored markers, printed Tips and Tricks sheet and Provider Handout
Ask providers to bring	A phone or calendar, and a list of their regular business tasks

Learning goals

By the end, each provider can:

1. Complete a one-week time audit of business tasks.
2. Sort tasks by urgency and importance.
3. Block weekly time for business work.
4. Choose one task to batch, automate, or delegate.

Agenda

Time	Segment
0:00 – 0:05	Welcome and opener: “What did you do last night after closing?”
0:05 – 0:15	Why time management matters: the owner’s two jobs
0:15 – 0:30	Time audits, priorities, batching, and delegating
0:30 – 0:45	Activity: Build your business hour
0:45 – 0:55	Implementation: your 30-day plan and one commitment
0:55 – 1:00	Takeaways and wrap-up

Why time management matters

Opener, “What did you do last night after closing?”: Ask providers to list business tasks they did after hours this week. Most lists include paperwork, billing, messages, shopping, and cleaning.

Talking points:

- **Owners have two jobs.** Caring for children and running a business both need time.

- **Business tasks get squeezed.** Without protected time, budgeting and planning happen late at night or not at all.
- **Time is money.** An hour spent on a task someone else could do is an hour not spent growing the business.
- **Small systems save hours.** Batching, templates, and routines add up over a year.
- **Rest is part of the plan.** Burnout is a business risk; sustainable hours keep programs open.

Core content: taking back your time

Step 1: Time audit

For one week, providers jot down business tasks in 30-minute blocks: billing, messages, shopping, paperwork, planning, cleaning, staff issues. The goal is honesty, not perfection.

Step 2: Sort by priority

	Urgent	Not urgent
Important	Do now (licensing deadline, payroll, a sick child)	Schedule it (budget review, marketing, planning)
Less important	Delegate or simplify (routine calls, supply runs)	Drop or limit (extra social media scrolling)

Step 3: Use time-saving strategies

- **Batch similar tasks.** Billing, messages, and shopping go in one block each instead of all day.
- **Use templates.** Reuse messages for reminders, tours, and policy updates.
- **Automate.** Autopay, recurring orders, and calendar reminders.
- **Delegate.** Hand off tasks to staff, family, or a service where possible.
- **Protect a business hour.** One weekly block that is just for running the business.

Implementation: your 30-day plan

Each provider leaves with one commitment and a 4-week plan; the Business Specialist checks progress at the next coaching session. Progress here also counts toward the pilot goal of at least one new or improved business practice per provider.

Week	Action	Done when
Week 1	Complete a one-week time audit.	Audit is done
Week 2	Sort tasks by urgency and importance; circle three to change.	Three tasks are chosen
Week 3	Block a weekly business hour on your calendar and protect it.	Business hour is held once
Week 4	Batch, automate, or delegate one task.	One task is off your plate

Tie-in to coaching

At the next individual coaching session, the Business Specialist will:

☐ Look at the time audit together

- ☐ Confirm the weekly business hour is happening
- ☐ Review the task that was batched, automated, or delegated
- ☐ Note any business practice change in the provider's progress record

Commitment card

Have providers fill this in before they leave and keep a copy:

- The task that takes most of my time: _____
- My weekly business hour is: _____
- The task I will batch, automate, or delegate: _____
- One way I will protect my rest: _____

Key takeaways

Close the session by reading these aloud; they also appear on the Provider Handout.

1. **Know where time goes.** A one-week audit shows the real picture.
2. **Schedule what matters.** Important work like budgeting needs a set time.
3. **Batch and automate.** Group similar tasks and let tools handle repeats.
4. **Share the load.** Delegate what others can do.
5. **Protect your rest.** A rested owner makes better business decisions.

Activities and discussion

Activity: Build your business hour (15 minutes)

Using the sample weekly schedule, providers find one realistic hour each week for business work (for example, nap time on Wednesday). They list what will happen in that hour: Budgeting Tool update, messages, billing. Pairs share how they'll protect the time.

Discussion questions

- What business task do you put off the longest?
- What task could someone else do for you?
- When during the day do you have the most energy for paperwork?
- What helps you stop working at the end of the day?

Peer Connections prompt (July)

"Balancing the business with the classroom." Providers share one routine, tool, or boundary that helps them get business work done without giving up evenings and weekends.

Handouts for this session

Walk through the **Time Management Tips and Tricks** sheet during the content segment, and give out the **Time Management Provider Handout** at the end.